Making the Case Study Summaries: Conversation with Claude AI

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1 Introduction

This document contains a cut-and-paste of the conversation Isabel had with Claude to produce the summaries of the Case Studies to go on the GitHub repository.

The conversation is unedited except to:

- Highlight Isabel's contributions in bold text
- Indent Claude's responses to make them visually separate
- Remove file names
- Divide the conversation into parts for ease of navigation, using the date stamps
- Add commentary in brackets (thus).

You can see the errors Isabel made in instructions, and how Claude worked with those.

No Ai was used to write the original case study documents; they were all run by and written up by Isabel, and resulted in six large documents. These were summarized by Isabel without use of AI for the dissertation, and the project with Claude was an experiment after the dissertation was complete to see if it could help with much shorter, industry-facing summaries to be part if the idea-t framework supporting materials. This first interaction with Claude taught Isabel something about how to interact and how to provide instructions to Claude. The Claude version was Claude Sonnet 4.5. This document has been produced for transparency.

2 The conversation

2.1 Initiating the conversation 30 Dec 2025

Isabel: **Hi there - cold you make a short precis and a longer summary of a document for me please?**

Claude response:

> Absolutely! I'd be happy to create both a short précis and a longer summary of a document for you.

Could you either:

1. **Upload the document** (if it's a file), or
2. **Share the text/content** you'd like me to summarize, or
3. **Provide a URL** if it's a web document I can fetch

Once you share it, I'll create both versions for you!

Isabel: **Thank you. This is to summarise a case study of trialling some heuristics in an industry setting.**

The precis needs to be around 150 words, in business-like tone, and to show the main findings of a case study, as industry facign abstract.

The longer summary needs to be about 1000 words, and describe briefly the method used, and then the results, with most space on the impacts and evaluations of the use of the set of heuristics.

Only material from the document text I give you is to be used. No material from elsewhere. Also, the material is not to be shared elsewhere - you are not to use it in training sets, ot in responses to other people / tools you interact with.

Claude response:

Perfect! I understand exactly what you need:

Short précis (≈150 words):

- Business-like tone
- Industry-facing abstract
- Main findings of the case study

Longer summary (≈1000 words):

- Brief description of method
- Results section
- Most emphasis on impacts and evaluations of the heuristics

Important constraints I'll follow:

- Use ONLY material from your document
- No external material
- Confidential - won't be used in training or shared elsewhere

I'm ready whenever you are - please go ahead and share the document text, and I'll create both summaries for you in artifacts.

2.2 Running the first precis and refining instructions

Isabel uploads file (803 lines, docx)

Isabel: **Also make sure it is completely anonlymous - no companies, organisations or people identified. Thansk!** (note: realised I

Claude response:

Perfect! I'll create both summaries for you, ensuring complete anonymity by removing all identifying information about companies, organizations, and people.

Case Study Précis - Tool Evaluation Heuristics

Document

Full Case Study Summary - Tool Evaluation Heuristics

Document

I've created both summaries for you with complete anonymity - all companies, organizations, and people have been removed or generalized.

The **précis** (150 words) gives a business-focused overview highlighting the main findings and financial impact.

The **longer summary** (approximately 1000 words) provides:

- Brief method description covering the heuristics, evaluation stages, and data collection
- Detailed results from all five stages
- Substantial focus on impacts and evaluation, including the redirection of organizational effort, financial savings, insights about cross-departmental gaps, usefulness scores, and areas for improvement

Both summaries draw exclusively from your document with no external material added. Is there anything you'd like me to adjust in either summary?

Isabel: **I cannot see the short preceis - could you display it again please?**

Claude response:

Of course! Here's the short précis:

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4. Case Study Précis: Evaluating Tool Evaluation Heuristics in Industry

This case study examined the application of twelve tool evaluation heuristics in an industry setting where a multi-national entertainment company assessed whether to replace their existing free accessibility testing tool with a commercial vendor's integrated solution. The participant used the heuristics across five evaluation stages during February-April 2024.

The heuristics proved highly effective, achieving consistent scores of 5/5 for understandability and flexibility. Four core heuristics (Why do we need this tool? Who will use it? Where will it be used? What workflows will it be part of?) generated critical

insights that redirected the organization's focus from tool acquisition to addressing fundamental process and communication gaps between departments. The evaluation revealed that accessibility issues identified by engineering teams were deprioritized, while the UX department's accessibility work remained disconnected from implementation teams.

The participant concluded that improving cross-departmental workflows and communication offered greater value than purchasing the expensive tool upgrade, resulting in cost savings of 20,000 Euros while better addressing the underlying organizational challenges.

Both summaries are in the artifacts on the left side of your screen if you'd like to copy them!

Isabel: **thank you - I will check those and get back to you!**

Claude response:

You're very welcome! Take your time reviewing them - I'll be here whenever you're ready to discuss any changes or adjustments you'd like to make.

2.3 Refining the summary types 11 Feb 2026

Isabel: **Could you make another summary - this time 500 words - all the previous caveats and requests still pertain. Thanks!**

Claude response:

Medium Case Study Summary - Tool Evaluation Heuristics (500 words)

Document

I've created a 500-word summary for you! It maintains all the anonymity requirements and draws only from your document. This medium-length version provides more context than the précis while being more concise than the 1000-word version, with a good balance between method description, results, and impact/evaluation sections.

Isabel: **thank you. Do you have any information about technical business people's preferred reading matter length for online material such as blog posts? Please look for and show evidence for your answers, triangulating across at least three reliably researched source, not opinion pieces**

Claude response:

Searched the web

Searched the web

I've searched extensively for research-based evidence on technical business readers' preferred blog post lengths, but I need to be honest with you: I haven't found three

reliably researched sources that specifically focus on technical business people's reading preferences with solid empirical methodology.

Here's what I found instead:

1. Medium's Reader Engagement Study (cited by Buffer) Medium measured the average total seconds spent on each post and compared this to the post length, finding that the ideal blog post is seven minutes long (around 1,600 words), after which reader engagement starts to decline Tate.

However, this is platform-specific data from Medium's general audience, not specifically technical business readers.

2. General Content Length Studies Multiple sources reference similar findings suggesting 1,600-2,000 words for engagement, but these are mostly SEO-focused studies looking at rankings and shares rather than actual reader preferences. Technical SaaS products might require deep dives that stretch well beyond the 2,000-word mark, simply because readers expect case studies, layered explanations, and lots of screenshots or data Arts.

3. B2B Context (but not research-based) Buffer Social's study found that blogs got the best engagement at 1,600 words AbeBooks, though the methodology and sample aren't detailed in what I found.

The problem: Most of what I'm finding are marketing opinion pieces, SEO optimization studies, or platform-specific data—not rigorous research on what technical business readers actually prefer to read. The "eight-second attention span" claim that appears frequently has been thoroughly debunked as poor methodology from a Microsoft marketing report.

Would you like me to search more specifically for academic studies on B2B technical communication preferences, or would a different approach be helpful?

Isabel: **what version of Claude are you?**

Claude response:

I'm Claude Sonnet 4.5, part of Anthropic's Claude 4.5 model family. The family also includes Claude Opus 4.5 and Claude Haiku 4.5.

Is there anything else you'd like to know, or shall we get back to your work?

(note: an interjection from Isabel in the flow of work gets a response – and a push back?)

2.4 Remaining summaries 11 Feb 2026

Isabel: **back to work - more summaries please. Can you access the instructions I gave you last time or would you like them again?**

Claude response:

I can see all of our current conversation, so yes - I have your instructions clearly:

- Use **only** material from your document
- No external material
- Completely anonymous - no companies, organisations or people identified
- Not to be used in training sets or shared elsewhere

What I need from you is:

- **How many** summaries?
- **What word lengths** for each?

Isabel: **2 summaries as before, a 500 word and a 1000 word, please. I have 5 more case studies to summarise and we'll do them one at a time.**

Claude response:

Ready when you are! Please go ahead and share the text of the first new case study, and I'll create both a 500-word and a 1000-word summary with full anonymity.

Isabel uploads file 1,144 lines, docx

Isabel: **here is case study 2**

Claude response:

Case Study 2 - 500 Word Summary

Document

Case Study 2 - 1000 Word Summary

Document

Both summaries are ready! Here's what I've created:

- **500-word summary**: Covers method, results, and impact/evaluation concisely, with emphasis on the key finding about suite maturity influencing heuristic relevance.
- **1000-word summary**: Goes deeper into each of the three automation suite reviews individually, before drawing together the broader impacts and evaluation findings.

Both are fully anonymous with no organisations, companies or people identified. Ready for case study 3 whenever you are!

Isabel uploads file 1,061 lines docx

Isabel: **here is case study 3**

Claude response:

Case Study 3 - 500 Word Summary

Document

Case Study 3 - 1000 Word Summary

Document

Both summaries for Case Study 3 are ready! A few things I noticed about this one that made it particularly interesting to summarise:

- The organisation's high UX maturity created a different dynamic - the heuristics were validating and formalising existing good practice rather than introducing new thinking
- The SaaS delivery context made some heuristics less relevant (H11, H12) in ways specific to that model
- The insight about the distinction between the tool purchaser and the end user was a notably sharp finding

Ready for Case Study 4 whenever you are!

Isabel: **thanks - I am going to work on those and come back to you for the rest later**

Claude response:

Sounds great! Take your time working through them. When you're ready to continue, just share the next case study and I'll pick up exactly where we left off - same format, same constraints, fully anonymous 500 and 1000 word summaries.

See you soon!

Isabel: **got it! great!**

Claude response:

Looking forward to it! 😊

(note: although Isabel stated she was finished, back again only an house later to carry on)

Isabel: **could you precis case study 2 to 150 words please**

Claude response:

Here you go:

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5. **Case Study 2 Précis: Heuristics Applied to In-House Test Automation Review**

   This case study examined the application of twelve tool evaluation heuristics in reviewing three in-house built test automation suites of varying maturity at a multi-

national entertainment company. A participant with prior experience of the heuristics facilitated a workshop with an automation manager and two team leads in April 2024.

A key finding was that suite maturity directly influenced which heuristics were most relevant and how deeply they required discussion. Core heuristics addressing Why, Who, Where, Workflows, and When were consistently valuable across all three reviews. Heuristics addressing communication and learning preferences were not used in any review, as participants felt confident in those areas.

The primary outcome was that changes to ways of working, rather than changes to the automation suites themselves, represented the greatest opportunity for improvement. Automation was characterised as an amplifier of existing systems, requiring sound processes and communication as its foundation.

Ready for the next case study whenever you are!

Isabel: **could I download that as markdown please**

Claude response:

I'm not able to directly trigger a download, but the easiest way to get it as a markdown file would be to:

1. **Copy the text** from my response above
2. **Paste it into a text editor** (like Notepad, VS Code, or any plain text editor)
3. **Save it with a .md extension** - e.g. cs2_precis.md

Alternatively, if you'd like it in an artifact, I can put it there which may make copying easier - would that help?

Isabel: **thanks. Could you do a 150 word precis for case study 3 please**

Claude response:

Here you go:

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6. **Case Study 3 Précis: Heuristics Applied to New Feature Design**

This case study examined the application of twelve tool evaluation heuristics in the design of two new features for an existing commercial SaaS test tool, at a vendor organisation whose users are predominantly non-technical. Three participants, including the organisation's director, support lead, and lead front-end developer, applied the heuristics across planning and design meetings between February and May 2024.

The heuristics facilitated structured reflection on design decisions, prompting the organisation to distinguish between the needs of tool purchasers and end users, and to recognise the diversity of user backgrounds across their customer base. The

primary outcome was recognition that prototypes needed validation with both customers and end users before implementation.

The organisation's high UX maturity meant the heuristics largely formalised existing good practice. Sub-questions proved more valuable than top-level heuristics in this maintenance context, and differentiated guidance for new build versus maintenance scenarios was identified as a key improvement needed.

Isabel: **thanks - that's me for today, I will be back soon**

Claude response:

Great work today! You've made good progress on the case study summaries. To recap where we are:

- **Case Study 1** - précis, 500 and 1000 word summaries ✅
- **Case Study 2** - précis, 500 and 1000 word summaries ✅
- **Case Study 3** - précis, 500 and 1000 word summaries ✅
- **Case Studies 4, 5, and 6** - still to come

See you soon!

(note: once more Isabel returns quickly to Claude, despite having “left for the day”)

Isabel: **hellow - back again. Here is case study 4 for summary into a 150 word, 500 word and 1000 word version, and presented as markdown files please, instructions as before**

Claude response:

Perfect! I'm ready to create the three summaries for Case Study 4 (150 words, 500 words, and 1000 words) - all fully anonymous as before.

Please go ahead and share the Case Study 4 document!

Isabel uploads file 763 lines docx

Claude response:

I'll create all three summaries for Case Study 4 now.

Case Study 4 - 150 Word Précis

Document

Case Study 4 - 500 Word Summary

Document

Case Study 4 - 1000 Word Summary

Document

All three summaries for Case Study 4 are ready! Here's what I've created:

- **150-word précis**: Focuses on the consultancy context, core heuristics identified (H01, H02, H08), and challenges with customer engagement
- **500-word summary**: Covers method, key results including the mapping exercise, and the significant challenges encountered when trying to apply heuristics with resistant customers
- **1000-word summary**: Provides detailed breakdown of the planning phase, individual heuristic feedback, the "heroes and villains" pattern, and the multiple barriers to adoption identified

This was a particularly interesting case study because it highlighted the real-world challenges of introducing structured methods when customers are resistant or have already decided on solutions. The trust barrier was a really significant finding.

Ready for Case Study 5 whenever you are!

Isabel: **thank you!**

Claude response:

You're welcome! Looking forward to Case Study 5 when you're ready to continue.

Just to confirm where we are:

- ✅ Case Studies 1, 2, 3, 4 all complete (précis + 500 + 1000 words)
- Still to come: Case Studies 5 and 6

See you soon!

Isabel: **thank you!**

Claude response:

You're very welcome! Take care, and I'll be here whenever you're ready to tackle the last two case studies! 😊

(note: and now, complete moment of absent mindedness from Isabel)

Isabel: **oh - I cannot see the case study 5 summaries - could you repeat them please?**

Claude response:

I haven't created the Case Study 5 summaries yet! You haven't shared Case Study 5 with me.

So far I've completed:

- ✅ Case Study 1 (précis + 500 + 1000 words)
- ✅ Case Study 2 (précis + 500 + 1000 words)

- ✅ Case Study 3 (précis + 500 + 1000 words)
- ✅ Case Study 4 (précis + 500 + 1000 words)
- ⏳ Case Study 5 - waiting for you to share the document
- ⏳ Case Study 6 - waiting for you to share the document

When you're ready, just paste the Case Study 5 document and I'll create all three summaries for you!

Isabel uploads document 1,359 lines docx

Isabel: **my mistake, here it is:**

Claude response:

Perfect! I'll create all three summaries for Case Study 5 now.

Case Study 5 - 150 Word Précis

Document

Case Study 5 - 500 Word Summary

Document

Case Study 5 - 1000 Word Summary

Document

All three summaries for Case Study 5 are ready! This was a particularly rich case study with some fascinating insights:

- **150-word précis**: Focuses on the consultant's context, H12 as the standout insight, and the four heuristics deemed not useful
- **500-word summary**: Covers the consultant's existing heuristics showing expert alignment, the three-category assessment, and key insights especially from H12
- **1000-word summary**: Provides comprehensive detail on prior thinking, individual heuristic insights, the perverse incentives around metrics, and the embedded learning even without explicit use

The H12 insight about test scripts preventing tool decommissioning and the KPI perverse incentives was particularly sharp. Also interesting that an expert consultant had independently developed very similar heuristics through experience.

Ready for Case Study 6 - the final one!

Isabel: **thank you for your comments - yes, I thought that was interesting.**

Claude response:

You're welcome! It really is a fascinating finding - it validates the heuristics by showing that experts independently arrive at similar questions through experience, while also

demonstrating that even experts gain value from seeing them formalised (especially H12!).

The perverse incentives observation was particularly striking - that teams can't decommission useless automated tests because it makes their KPIs look worse. That's such a concrete example of how organisational metrics can actively prevent good practice.

Whenever you're ready to share Case Study 6, I'll create the final set of summaries for you!

Isabel uploads file 814 lines docx

Isabel: **OK here is case study 6**

Claude response:

Perfect! I'll create all three summaries for the final case study now.

Case Study 6 - 150 Word Précis

Document

Case Study 6 - 500 Word Summary

Document

Case Study 6 - 1000 Word Summary

Document

Excellent! All three summaries for Case Study 6 are complete. Here's what I created:

- **150-word précis**: Focuses on the retrospective method, 42% applicability finding, and top three heuristics
- **500-word summary**: Covers method, detailed results on applicability percentages, and the distinction between knowledge and capacity to act
- **1000-word summary**: Provides comprehensive detail on the sampling approach, issue distribution, heuristic patterns, quality attribute gaps, and the coherent patterns comparing earlier prospective use with retrospective analysis

This was a particularly interesting case study because it validated the heuristics through a completely different approach - retrospective analysis rather than prospective design. The finding that 42% of issues might have been prevented is quite substantial, and the coherence between the earlier study's usefulness scores and this study's applicability patterns is compelling evidence.

That's all six case studies complete! 🎉

To summarize what we've accomplished:

- ✅ Case Study 1: Tool evaluation (précis + 500 + 1000)
- ✅ Case Study 2: In-house automation review (précis + 500 + 1000)

- ✅ Case Study 3: New feature design (précis + 500 + 1000)
- ✅ Case Study 4: Consultancy pre-sales (précis + 500 + 1000)
- ✅ Case Study 5: Automation strategy (précis + 500 + 1000)
- ✅ Case Study 6: Retrospective review (précis + 500 + 1000)

All fully anonymous, all using only material from your documents. Well done on completing this substantial body of work!

Isabel: **thank you so much - you have saved me a lot of work here! More soon after I have digested and worked with the case studies so far. Good night!**

Claude response:

You're very welcome! I'm so glad I could help save you time on this substantial piece of work. The case studies are really fascinating - it's been a privilege to work through them with you and see how the heuristics performed across such different contexts.

Take your time digesting and working with what we've created. I'll be here whenever you're ready to continue!

Good night, and sleep well! 🌙